holdings. Though these reforms and in particular the latter were justified partly in terms of achieving efficiency in agriculture, it is clear from the acts themselves and from the political manifestos supporting the acts that the main impetus driving the first three reforms was poverty reduction.

Land Reforms since Independence

The peculiarities of Indian agriculture, combined with the declared desire to bring about economic development as well as social justice led the govt., in the post-Independence period, to under-take a comprehensive programme of land reforms.

In short these reforms aimed at

- Abolition of Zamindars and intermediaries (middle men)
- Bringing land celing
- Protoection of tenants, tillers and labourers
- Cooperation among farming community

(a) Abolition of Intermediaries

One of the first aims of the agrarian reforms was to eliminate the middlemen such as the Zamindars and Jagirdars so as to bring the cultivator into direct relationship with the govt. The work of Zamindari abolition was comparatively easy in the temporarily settled areas such as Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh where adequate records and administrative machinery existed.

(b) Land ceiling

In order to achieve equality in possession and utilization of land, legislations were passed in all states imposing ceiling on existing land holdings as well as on future acquisition of land. However, provisions relating to level, transfers, and exemptions differed considerably from state to state. In Assam, Jammu and Kashmir, West Bengal and Manipur, there was one uniform ceiling limit irrespective of the class of land, ceiling being fixed at 50 acres, 22 ¾ acres and 25 acres respectively. But due to differences in uniformity among states, land celling became a political issue and was not properly implemented.

Tanjore Pannaiyaal Protection Act- 1952

At the time of independence, the feudal Serfdom system was followed in then undivided Tanjore area. Small tenant peasants and agri-worker severely suffered by this brutal system. To safeguard small tenants and agri - workers, the *Pannaiyaal Paathukaappu Sattam* (Tanjore Pannaiyaal Protection Act 1952) was implemented. In due course under needs of circumstances this act was expanded all over the state. As this act implements, all tenant peasants got their appropriate share in cultivation. Further more, Land Ceiling Act, 1961 was also enacted and updated subsequently for the needs of time. By this act, the surplus lands were taken from the landlords who possessed the land more than permissible level. These lands were distributed to landless peasants and agri – workers.

(c) Tenant Regulation

Third attempt was to bring uniformity and regulation of agrarian labour and tenancy. Consequently, governments in the Centre and States have formulated agrarian policy aimed at reducing disparities in wealth and income, eliminating exploitation, providing security for the

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